BlueCross BlueShield Arizona

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EVIDENCE-BASED CRITERIA	**ORIGINAL EFFECTIVE DATE:**	**09/19/22**
SECTION: VISION	**LAST REVIEW DATE:**	**08/16/22**
	CURRENT EFFECTIVE DATE:	**09/19/22**
	LAST CRITERIA REVISION DATE:	
NEXT ANNUAL REVIEW DATE: 3RD QTR 2023	**ARCHIVE DATE:**	

RETINAL PROSTHESIS

Non-Discrimination Statement and Multi-Language Interpreter Services information are located at the end of this document.

Coverage for services, procedures, medical devices and drugs are dependent upon benefit eligibility as outlined in the member's specific benefit plan. This Evidence-Based Criteria must be read in its entirety to determine coverage eligibility, if any.

This Evidence-Based Criteria provides information related to coverage determinations only and does not imply that a service or treatment is clinically appropriate or inappropriate. The provider and the member are responsible for all decisions regarding the appropriateness of care. Providers should provide BCBSAZ complete medical rationale when requesting any exceptions to these guidelines.

The section identified as "Description" defines or describes a service, procedure, medical device or drug and is in no way intended as a statement of medical necessity and/or coverage.

The section identified as "Criteria" defines criteria to determine whether a service, procedure, medical device or drug is considered medically necessary or experimental or investigational.

State or federal mandates, e.g., FEP program, may dictate that any drug, device or biological product approved by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA) may not be considered experimental or investigational and thus the drug, device or biological product may be assessed only on the basis of medical necessity.

Evidence-Based Criteria are subject to change as new information becomes available.

For purposes of this Evidence-Based Criteria, the terms "experimental" and "investigational" are considered to be interchangeable.

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RETINAL PROSTHESIS (cont.)

Description:

A retinal prosthesis replaces lost photoreceptor function by transmitting external images to an array of electrodes or via light sensors placed in the epiretinal or subretinal space. The artificial retina could restore sight to individuals with blindness secondary to retinal diseases, such as retinitis pigmentosa, hereditary retinal degeneration, and some forms of agerelated macular degeneration. Several models of retinal prostheses are in development in the United States, Europe, and Asia. Only the Argus® II Retinal Prosthesis System has been cleared for use by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration (FDA).

In 2013, the Argus® II Retinal Prosthesis System was cleared for marketing by the FDA through a humanitarian use device exemption. This exemption is limited to devices that treat or diagnose fewer than 4000 people in the United States each year. The Argus® II system is intended for use in adults, age 25 years or older, with severe-to-profound retinitis pigmentosa who have bare light perception (can perceive light, but not the direction from which it is coming) or no light perception in both eyes, evidence of intact inner layer retina function, and a history of the ability to see forms. Individuals must also be willing and able to receive the recommended postimplant clinical follow-up, device fitting, and visual rehabilitation.

Criteria:

- Retinal prostheses are considered ***experimental or investigational*** when any **ONE** or more of the following criteria are met:

    1. Lack of final approval from the appropriate governmental regulatory bodies (e.g., Food and Drug Administration); or
    2. Insufficient scientific evidence to permit conclusions concerning the effect on health outcomes; or
    3. Insufficient evidence to support improvement outside the investigational setting.

Resources:

Literature reviewed 08/16/22. We do not include marketing materials, poster boards and non-published literature in our review.

1. da Cruz L, Coley BF, Dorn J, et al. The Argus II epiretinal prosthesis system allows letter and word reading and long-term function in patients with profound vision loss. *Br J Ophthalmol*. May 2013;97(5):632-6. doi:10.1136/bjophthalmol-2012-301525

2. da Cruz L, Dorn JD, Humayun MS, et al. Five-Year Safety and Performance Results from the Argus II Retinal Prosthesis System Clinical Trial. *Ophthalmology*. Oct 2016;123(10):2248-54. doi:10.1016/j.ophtha.2016.06.049

RETINAL PROSTHESIS (cont.)

Resources: (cont.)

3. Dagnelie G, Christopher P, Arditi A, et al. Performance of real-world functional vision tasks by blind subjects improves after implantation with the Argus® II retinal prosthesis system. *Clin Exp Ophthalmol*. Mar 2017;45(2):152-159. doi:10.1111/ceo.12812

4. Fontanarosa J, Treadwell JR, Samson DJ, VanderBeek BL, Schoelles K. AHRQ Technology Assessments. *Retinal Prostheses in the Medicare Population*. Agency for Healthcare Research and Quality (US); 2016.

5. Geruschat DR, Richards TP, Arditi A, et al. An analysis of observer-rated functional vision in patients implanted with the Argus II Retinal Prosthesis System at three years. *Clin Exp Optom*. May 2016;99(3):227-32. doi:10.1111/cxo.12359

6. Ho AC, Humayun MS, Dorn JD, et al. Long-Term Results from an Epiretinal Prosthesis to Restore Sight to the Blind. *Ophthalmology*. Aug 2015;122(8):1547-54. doi:10.1016/j.ophtha.2015.04.032

7. Humayun MS, Dorn JD, da Cruz L, et al. Interim results from the international trial of Second Sight's visual prosthesis. *Ophthalmology*. Apr 2012;119(4):779-88. doi:10.1016/j.ophtha.2011.09.028

8. Kotecha A, Zhong J, Stewart D, da Cruz L. The Argus II prosthesis facilitates reaching and grasping tasks: a case series. *BMC Ophthalmol*. May 23 2014;14:71. doi:10.1186/1471-2415-14-71

Coding:

CPT:	00140, 0100T, 0472T, 0473T
HCPCS:	C1841, C1842, L8608, V2799

History:	**Date**:	**Activity**:
Medical Policy Panel	08/16/22	Approved guideline (Effective 9/19/22)
Medical Director (Dr. Deering)	07/05/22	Development

Policy Revisions:

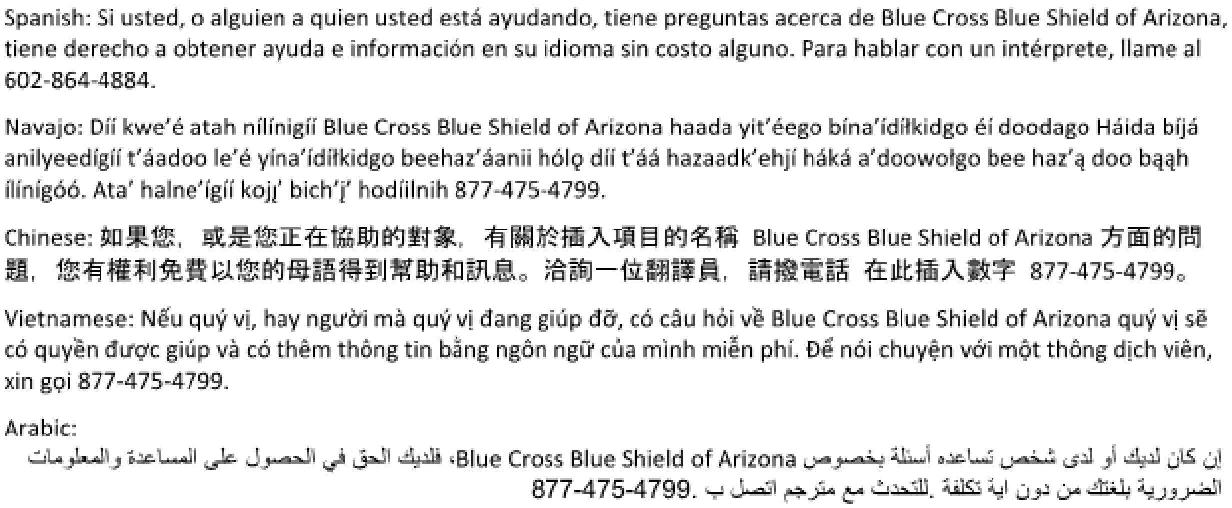
RETINAL PROSTHESIS (cont.)

Non-Discrimination Statement:

Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona (BCBSAZ) complies with applicable Federal civil rights laws and does not discriminate on the basis of race, color, national origin, age, disability or sex. BCBSAZ provides appropriate free aids and services, such as qualified interpreters and written information in other formats, to people with disabilities to communicate effectively with us. BCBSAZ also provides free language services to people whose primary language is not English, such as qualified interpreters and information written in other languages. If you need these services, call (602) 864-4884 for Spanish and (877) 475-4799 for all other languages and other aids and services.

If you believe that BCBSAZ has failed to provide these services or discriminated in another way on the basis of race, color, national origin, age, disability or sex, you can file a grievance with: BCBSAZ's Civil Rights Coordinator, Attn: Civil Rights Coordinator, Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona, P.O. Box 13466, Phoenix, AZ 85002-3466, (602) 864-2288, TTY/TDD (602) 864-4823, crc@azblue.com. You can file a grievance in person or by mail or email. If you need help filing a grievance BCBSAZ's Civil Rights Coordinator is available to help you. You can also file a civil rights complaint with the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, Office for Civil Rights electronically through the Office for Civil Rights Complaint Portal, available at https://ocrportal.hhs.gov/ocr/portal/lobby.jsf, or by mail or phone at: U.S. Department of Health and Human Services, 200 Independence Avenue SW., Room 509F, HHH Building, Washington, DC 20201, 1–800–368–1019, 800–537–7697 (TDD). Complaint forms are available at http://www.hhs.gov/ocr/office/file/index.html

Multi-Language Interpreter Services:



Spanish: Si usted, o alguien a quien usted está ayudando, tiene preguntas acerca de Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona, tiene derecho a obtener ayuda e información en su idioma sin costo alguno. Para hablar con un intérprete, llame al 602-864-4884.

Navajo: Díí kwe'é atah nílínigíí Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona haada yit'éego bína'ídíłkidgo éí doodago Háida bíjá anilyeedígíí t'áadoo le'é yína'ídíłkidgo beehaz'áanii hólǫ díí t'áá hazaadk'ehjí háká a'doowołgo bee haz'ą doo bąąh ílínígóó. Ata' halne'ígíí kojį' bich'į' hodíilnih 877-475-4799.

Chinese: 如果您，或是您正在協助的對象，有關於插入項目的名稱 Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona 方面的問題，您有權利免費以您的母語得到幫助和訊息。洽詢一位翻譯員，請撥電話 在此插入數字 877-475-4799。

Vietnamese: Nếu quý vị, hay người mà quý vị đang giúp đỡ, có câu hỏi về Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona quý vị sẽ có quyền được giúp và có thêm thông tin bằng ngôn ngữ của mình miễn phí. Để nói chuyện với một thông dịch viên, xin gọi 877-475-4799.

Arabic:
إن كان لديك أو لدى شخص تساعده أسئلة بخصوص Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona، فلديك الحق في الحصول على المساعدة والمعلومات
الضرورية بلغتك من دون اية تكلفة. للتحدث مع مترجم اتصل ب 877-475-4799.

RETINAL PROSTHESIS (cont.)

Multi-Language Interpreter Services: (cont.)

Tagalog: Kung ikaw, o ang iyong tinutulangan, ay may mga katanungan tungkol sa Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona, may karapatan ka na makakuha ng tulong at impormasyon sa iyong wika ng walang gastos. Upang makausap ang isang tagasalin, tumawag sa 877-475-4799.

Korean: 만약 귀하 또는 귀하가 돕고 있는 어떤 사람이 Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona 에 관해서 질문이 있다면 귀하는 그러한 도움과 정보를 귀하의 언어로 비용 부담없이 얻을 수 있는 권리가 있습니다. 그렇게 통역사와 얘기하기 위해서는 877-475-4799 로 전화하십시오.

French: Si vous, ou quelqu'un que vous êtes en train d'aider, a des questions à propos de Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona, vous avez le droit d'obtenir de l'aide et l'information dans votre langue à aucun coût. Pour parler à un interprète, appelez 877-475-4799.

German: Falls Sie oder jemand, dem Sie helfen, Fragen zum Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona haben, haben Sie das Recht, kostenlose Hilfe und Informationen in Ihrer Sprache zu erhalten. Um mit einem Dolmetscher zu sprechen, rufen Sie bitte die Nummer 877-475-4799 an.

Russian: Если у вас или лица, которому вы помогаете, имеются вопросы по поводу Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona, то вы имеете право на бесплатное получение помощи и информации на вашем языке. Для разговора с переводчиком позвоните по телефону 877-475-4799.

Japanese: ご本人様、またはお客様の身の回りの方でも、Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona についてご質問がございましたら、ご希望の言語でサポートを受けたり、情報を入手したりすることができます。料金はかかりません。通訳とお話される場合、877-475-4799 までお電話ください。

Farsi:
اگر شما، یا کسی که شما به او کمک میکنید ، سوال در مورد Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona ، داشته باشید حق این را دارید که کمک و
اطلاعات به زبان خود را به طور رایگان دریافت نمایید 877-475-4799
تماس حاصل نمایید.]

Assyrian:
[illegible] Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona [illegible]
[illegible] 877-475-4799.

Serbo-Croatian: Ukoliko Vi ili neko kome Vi pomažete ima pitanje o Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona, imate pravo da besplatno dobijete pomoć i informacije na Vašem jeziku. Da biste razgovarali sa prevodiocem, nazovite 877-475-4799.

Thai: หากคณ หรอคนทคณกาลงชวยเหลอมคาถามเกยวกบ Blue Cross Blue Shield of Arizona คณมสทธทจะไดรบความชวยเหลอและขอมลในภาษา ของคณไดโดยไมมคาใชจาย พดคยกบลาม โทร 877-475-4799